responses such as basic `404` responses and reexecutes the middleware pipeline to generate a pretty HTML response for the error. This gives users a much nicer experience when they encounter an error browsing your Razor Pages app.

We'll start by taking a quick look at the responsibilities of a page handler before we move on to see how the Razor Page infrastructure selects which page handler to execute.

15.1 Razor Pages and page handlers

In chapter 13 I described the Model-View-Controller (MVC) design pattern and showed how it relates to ASP.NET Core. In this design pattern, the "controller" receives a request and is the entry point for UI generation. For Razor Pages, the entry point is the page handler that resides in a Razor Page's `PageModel`. A *page handler* is a method that runs in response to a request.

The responsibility of a page handler is generally threefold:

- Confirm that the incoming request is valid.
- Invoke the appropriate business logic corresponding to the incoming request.
- Choose the appropriate kind of response to return.

A page handler doesn't need to perform all these actions, but at the very least it must choose the kind of response to return. Page handlers typically return one of three things: